How to learn Spanish with stories

A free, one-page method you can start today

Why stories work

Stories give words a context, so you remember them because of what happened, not because of a list. You also meet grammar the way native speakers use it, inside real sentences, which means you absorb patterns before you have to name them.

Start with a level check

On the website, take the level check to find your starting level. It takes about 10 minutes and you can retake it any time. If you only have this PDF, start with the first A1 story.

The routine (20–30 minutes per story)

- **Listen and read.** Tap a word for its meaning, or play the audio and follow the text. Aim for the main idea, not every word.
- **Read again with the translation.** Compare the two languages.
- **Review.** Study the bold vocabulary, then recall each meaning before you check it.
- **Quiz.** Answer the comprehension and grammar questions, then reread what you missed.
- **Write.** Answer the story prompt in your own words. Reuse words from the story.
- **Speak.** Read aloud, retell the story, then try the role-play.
- **Come back later.** A reread after a few days feels easier. That is progress.

Which level should I start with?

Level	You can…	Stories use…
A1	greet people and talk about daily life in simple sentences	present tense, short sentences, about 100–200 words
A2	tell what happened yesterday and describe people and places	past tenses (preterite and imperfect), about 250–410 words
B1	follow longer stories and explain your opinions	all common past tenses, future, conditional, the present subjunctive, about 470–830 words
B2	read complex texts and understand implied meaning	advanced subjunctive, passive, idioms, about 710–1,090 words
C1	follow demanding texts and use Spanish flexibly	subjunctive in all tenses, passives, formal connectors, idiom, about 1,290–1,450 words

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Fiction: characters are invented; places and history are real.

C2	understand almost everything and catch irony and subtext	literary and legal registers, irony, dialect, about 1,540–1,790 words

If you are unsure, start with the first A1 story. If it feels too easy, jump ahead; if the next level feels too hard, go back one level and read more stories there. Reading many easy stories builds fluency faster than struggling through hard ones.

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